

Aspirational Abstract: Surviving the clasroom (literally) [1]

Camille Bergeron

Department of Economics
University of Washingtony
Seattle, WA

October 15, 2026

[1]Potential aspirational abstracts for my research. THESE ARE ALL IMAGINARY. DO NOT TAKE AT FACE VALUE

Abstract

Measuring the returns to education has typically been a difficult endeavor as the problem is inherently nonparametric. To better evaluate educational policy and potential returns to education, I propose using a survival function estimated via kernel methods, relaxing the linearity assumptions embedded in standard human capital models. Existing approaches impose separability between education and experience and assume a fixed, linear rate of return for every year of schooling — assumptions that are particularly restrictive when modeling female educational trajectories, where family-level selection and time-varying treatment are prevalent. Using data[1] from a randomized control trial in Ghana [2] to train the a *survival kernet* [3] deep learning and select hyperparamters and report performance relative to traditional OLS and survival method metrics. With these estimates, I also report the predictive groupings. Results show that a weighted average grouping of birth, child order, and clan ties is a significant predictor for schooling survival rates. We find also that controlling for father's education, time of first menses s not influential. [4]

[1]The main feedback given to me from you was about **how** I planned to do this and what data, so this version of the abstract is perhaps a bit lengthy on that note just to address the previous comment

[2]Intergenerational Impacts of Secondary Education:Experimental Evidence from Ghana data, https://www.openicpsr.org/openicpsr/project/241205/version/V1/view

[3]https://jmlr.org/papers/volume25/22-0667/22-0667.pdf

[4]the other feedback I received was along the lines of synthesizing the idea of non paramteric modeling and also right censoring. https://arxiv.org/abs/2603.22914 adresses this and says it van be identified via an exclusion restriction: X and Y affect the primary risk margin S_1, but have no effect on the censoring margin S_2 or the copula dependence C. The intuition here is that we see proportion changes and measure the differences.